

WRITING BUILDING BLOCKS

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FUNCTIONAL ENGLISH(THEORY)

CONJUNCTIONS

A conjunction connects and shows a relationship between words, phrases, or clauses. Conjunctions are always used within the sentences.

For Example:

- *I bought pen and pencil.*
- *When you are not here, the house seems very empty.*

TYPES OF CONJUNCTIONS

COORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS

Connect independent clauses, words, phrases and clauses of equal rank: noun with noun, adjective with adjective and so on.

FANBOYS

For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So.

- Bring a pencil and paper tomorrow.
- Did she go to the store or to the game?

SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS

Connect dependent clauses with main clauses.

after, because, although, as, as if, as long as, before, if, since, when, where, whereas, wherever, whenever

- Although she was in pain, she stayed in game.
- She stayed in game because she was needed.

FUNCTIONS	EXPLANATION	EXAMPLES
FOR	means because. It introduces the cause of a cause–effect relationship	The car that the police seized at the crime scene had been sold in auction, for no one came forward to claim it. (The reason the car was sold was because no one claimed it.)
AND	adds information	Diabetes is a serious disease, and it is becoming more common. (The second part of the sentence gives more information about diabetes)
NOR	removes alternatives. It tells what something is not, rather than what it is	The discussion was not exciting, nor was it informative. (This sentence tells us two things that the discussion was not.)
BUT	contradicts, offers a contrast, or introduces something unexpected	Smoking has been linked to health problems, but many people continue to smoke. (Many people smoking contrasts with the fact that smoking causes health problems.)

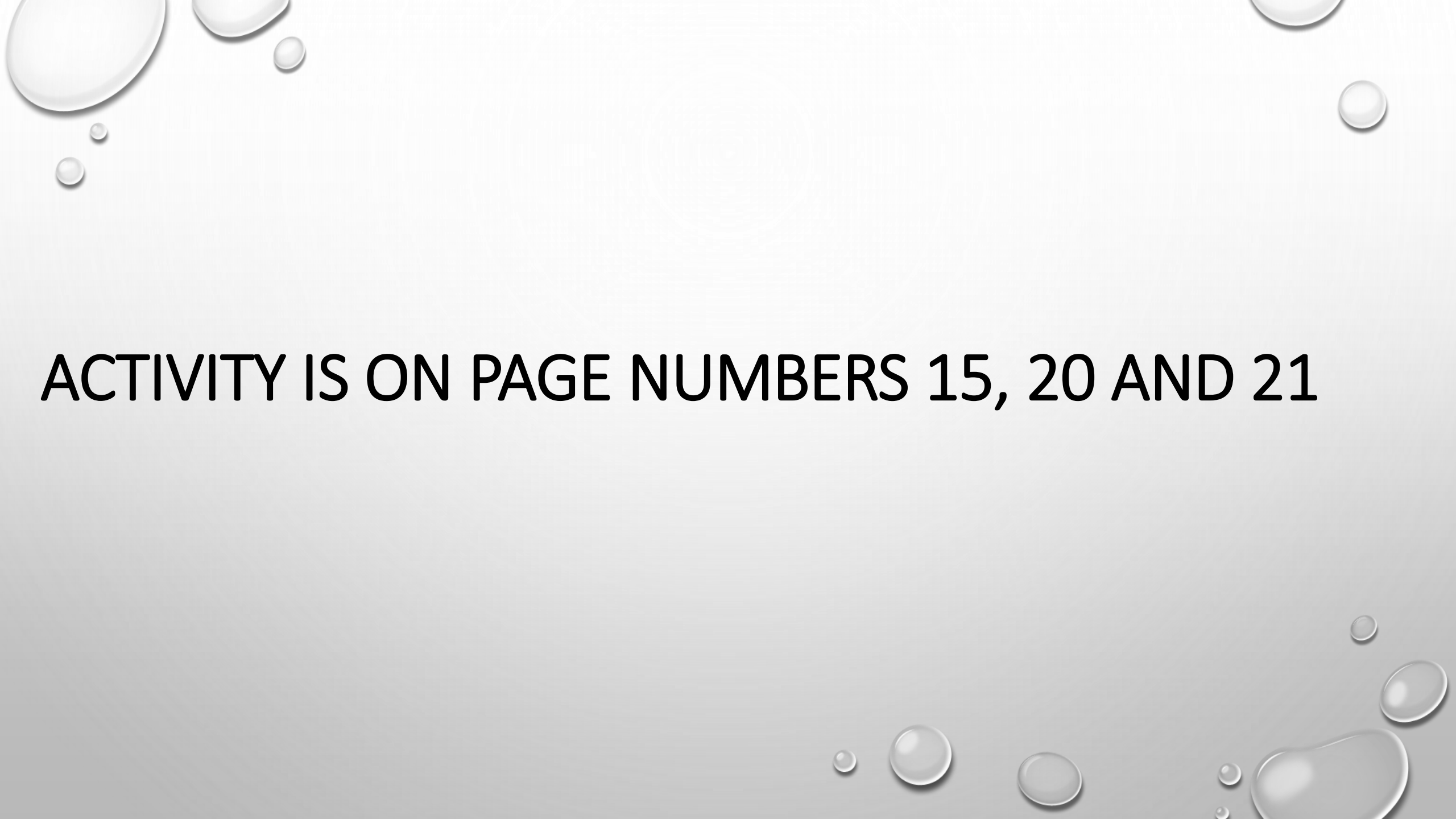
CONJUNCTIONS	EXPLANATION	EXAMPLES
OR	offers a choice	The professor may give the students a take-home exam, or he will have them write research papers. (The professor has a choice: requiring an exam or a paper, but not both.)
YET	expresses a stronger contrast than but	Boris works ten hours a day, yet he has time to volunteer at a homeless shelter. (It is very surprising that Boris has time left for volunteering.)
SO	means as a result. It introduces the effect of a cause-effect relationship	The president did not come because of illness, so someone else gave the achievement awards on her behalf. (Someone else giving the awards is the result of the president's illness.)

• SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS

Subordinating conjunctions are essential parts of complex sentences.

Examples:

- **As** Sherri blew out the candles atop her birthday cake, she caught her hair on fire.
- Sara begins to sneeze ***whenever*** she opens the window to get a breath of fresh air.

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CORRELATIVE CONJUNCTIONS

As suggested by their name, correlative conjunctions correlate, working in pairs to join phrases or words that carry equal importance within a sentence.

Examples:

- She is ***both*** intelligent ***and*** beautiful.
- I will ***either*** go for a hike ***or*** stay home and watch tv.
- He is ***not only*** intelligent ***but also*** very funny.



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CONJUNCTIVE ADVERBS/TRANSITION WORDS

Conjunctive adverbs are parts of speech that are used to connect one clause to another. They are also used to show sequence, contrast, cause and effect, and other relationships.

EXAMPLES:

- Jeremy kept talking in class; ***therefore***, he got in trouble.
- She went into the store; ***however***, she didn't find anything she wanted to buy.
- My car payments are high; ***on the other hand***, I really enjoy driving such a nice vehicle.

CONJUNCTIVE ADVERBS LIST

Any way	Certainly	Conversely	Henceforth
Again	Comparatively	Elsewhere	Hence
As a result	consequently	Equally	However
Almost	Contrarily	Eventually	Elsewhere
In addition	Comparatively	Finally	Furthermore

- **CONJUNCTIVE ADVERBS** connect two independent clause or they can be used in a simple sentence/independent clause.

PUNCTUATION GUIDELINES

- When a conjunctive adverb appears in the middle of an independent clause, it is usually surrounded by commas.
- When it appears at the beginning of an independent clause (but not connecting it to another clause), it is followed by a comma.
- When a conjunctive adverb connects two independent clauses, it's typically preceded by a semicolon and followed by a comma.

PUNCTUATION GUIDELINES

COMMA WITH FANBOYS:

Use before coordinating conjunctions between two independent clauses.

Example: movie was good, but tickets were expensive.

COMMA WITH DEPENDENT CLAUSES:

- Use after a dependent clause that precedes the main clause.

Example: When the bus arrived, we boarded.

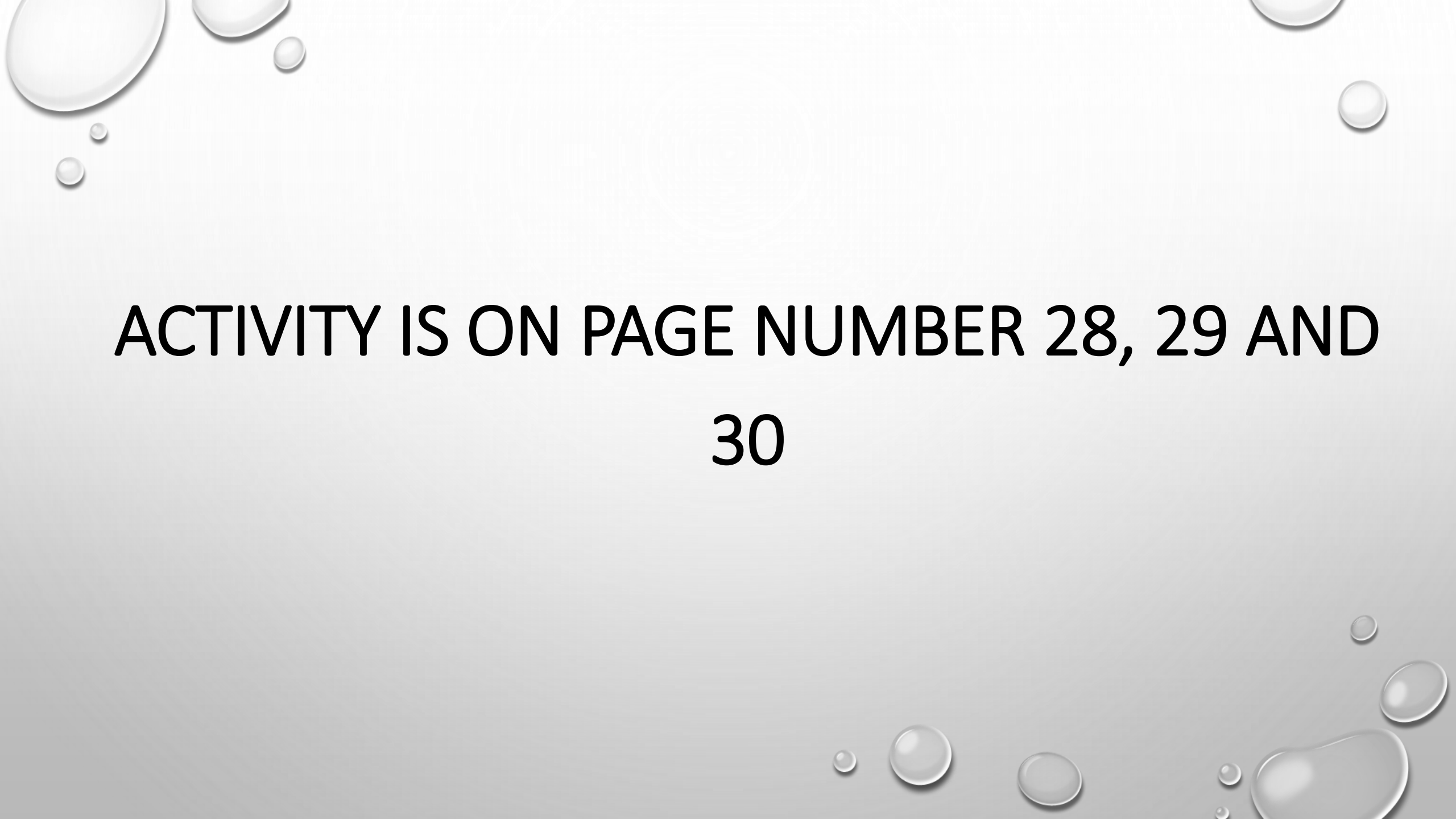
- No comma if the dependent clause follows the main clause.

Example: She stayed because she was needed.



SEMICOLON USAGE:

- Use between two independent clauses if there is no coordinating conjunction.
Example: the bus arrived; we boarded.
 - Use before conjunctive adverbs (in a sentence with two independent clauses) with a comma after them.
Example: Car payments are high; however, I enjoy driving it.
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